Lead With Your Heart

The GetOutSoftware Project:
Research, Insights, and Recommendations

Group Members

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Agenda

- ➔ Client Information
- ➔ Project Objectives and Methodology
- ➔ Secondary Research Analysis
  - ◆ 2013 High River Flood Breakdown
  - ◆ 2016 Wood Buffalo Wildfire Breakdown
- ➔ Industry Insights and Technology Gaps
- ➔ 4Ps and SWOT Analysis
- ➔ What Would Help Respondents and Evacuees?
- ➔ Key Features and Business Model Canvas
- ➔ Next Steps

Client Information

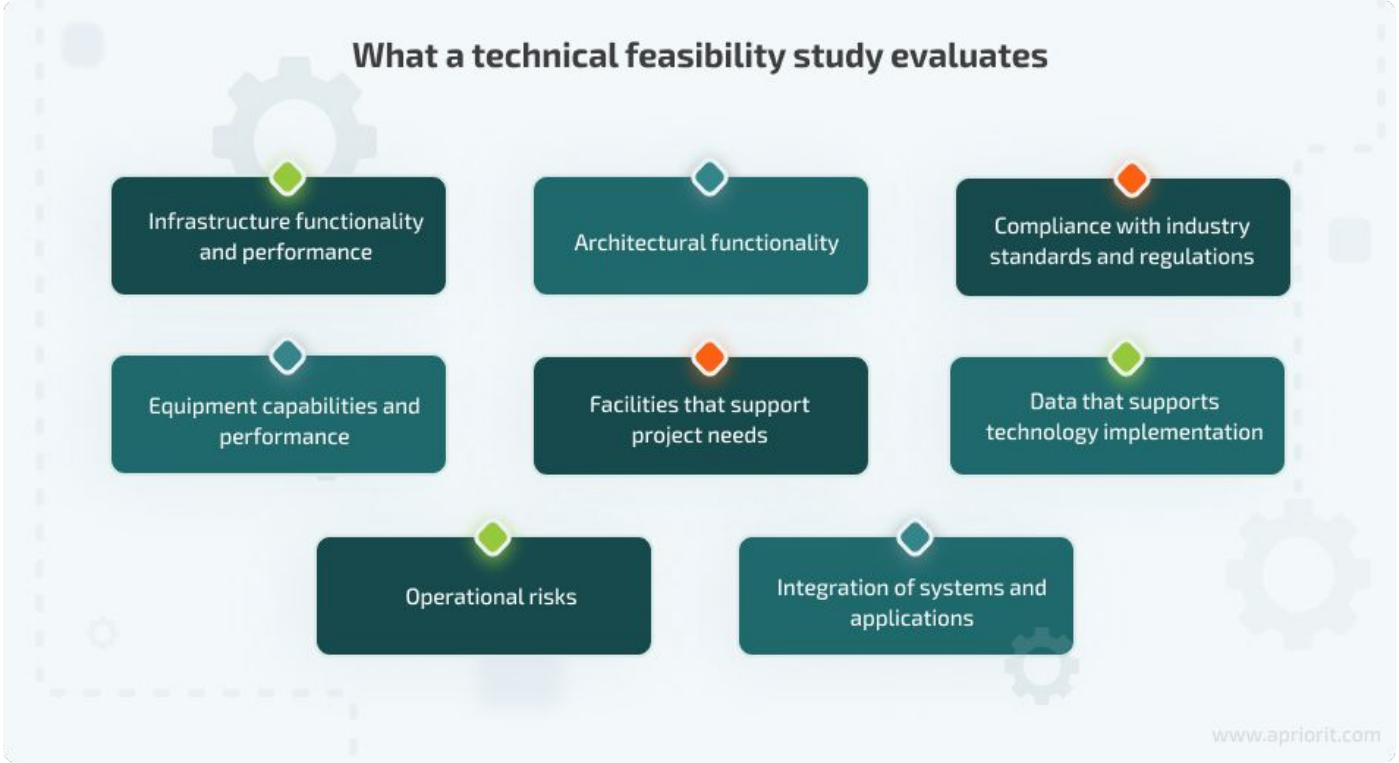
Lead Services is the brainchild of the Founder and CEO, Sheri Easterbrook. It stemmed from the loss of a childhood friend that was involved in a shooting incident. This led to a need or a necessity to build better ways to respond to crisis in rural communities.

The organization is focused particularly on building resilience in children and youth within the context of disaster management. They support communities in strengthening their capacity to protect vulnerable populations. Currently, Sheri is looking to develop a new software called GetOutSoftware.

Sheri

Project Objectives

- Assess the feasibility and design requirements for developing a new emergency management software solution called GetOutSoftware in collaboration with Lead Services.

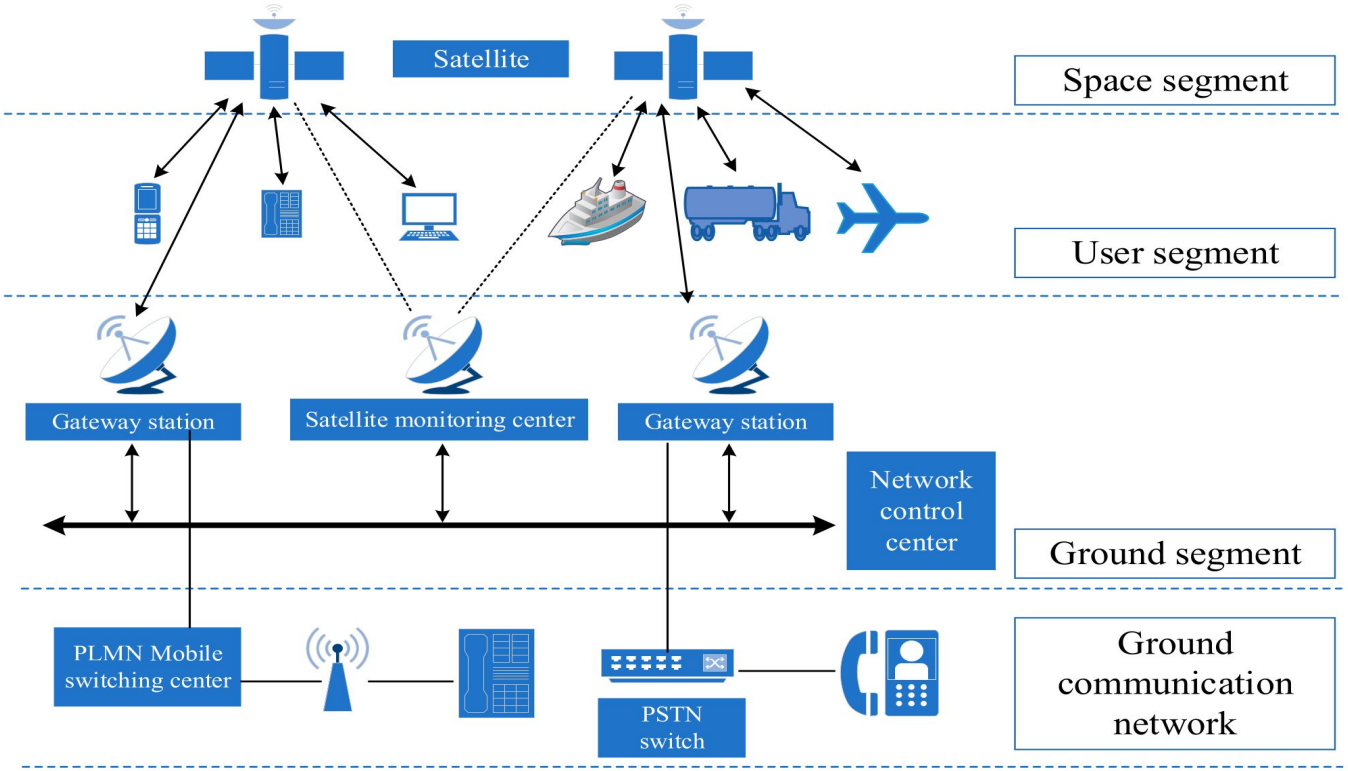


Project Objectives

- ➔ Identify and define the key features needed to support safe, efficient, and inclusive evacuations during disasters, especially in rural, remote, and vulnerable communities.

Project Objectives

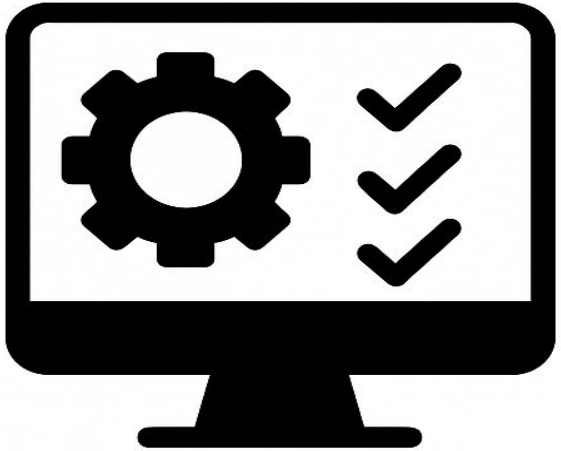
- Address gaps in current emergency response systems, including poor communication infrastructure, lack of interoperability, and limited accessibility in existing tools.



Methodology

After-Action
Report Analysis

Interviews with
Emergency
Professionals



Evaluation of
Existing Platforms

2013 High River Flood Breakdown

Overview

-Severe flooding in High River, Alberta

-Required large-scale evacuation.

-Disruption of traditional and digital communication systems

What Went Wrong

-Town website crashed from high traffic

-Cell networks & landlines failed

-EOC radio channels overloaded

-Reception Centres lacked updates

-Missed alerts

What Went Right

-Early activation of crisis comms team

-Social media alerts

-Town Crier newsletter (email + print)

-Mayor's radio updates

-Bullhorns & door-to-door alerts

-ARES (Amateur Radio Emergency Service)

Lessons Learned

-Move websites to cloud servers

-Add backup sat phones, boosters

-Set up evacuee tracking

-Send EOC updates to reception centres

-Distribute printed emergency info

2016 Wood Buffalo Wildfire Breakdown

Overview

-Wildfire began May 1, grew rapidly

-88,000+ evacuated in one day

-1,958 structures lost; 589,000 hectares burned

-No fire-related deaths, but 2 killed in car crash

What Went Wrong

-Re-entry authority unclear between agencies

-Prevention underfunded: $53M spent vs. $8.9B in losses

-Communication interoperability

-Emergency info not fully accessible to all

What Went Right

-Evacuation completed in one day

-Registration centres quickly set up

-Firefighters protected key infrastructure

-Telephone town halls connected evacuees

-Rapid Damage Assessment website helped re-entry

Lessons Learned

-Clarify roles in emergency legislation

-Invest more in prevention and risk reduction

-Improve emergency comms (accessibility + tech)

-Develop local Disaster Resiliency Strategies

Industry Insights & Technology Gaps

01

Complexity

02

Fragmentation

03

Outdated Communication Technology

04

Inefficient Alert System

Complexity

- Existing software tends to be overly complex
- Gets in the way during emergencies
- Requires extensive training
- Sometimes requires a special support team on site, which significantly hinders efficiency

Fragmentation

- There isn't one solution to all problems
- Causes interoperability issues
- Leads to incomplete data flows between software
- Creates a larger attack surface and more privacy/security concerns

Outdated Communication Technology

- ➔ Communications are often carried out via landline, mobile phone, radio, and SMS
- ➔ Falls back to face-to-face, or nothing at all
- ➔ Existing solutions lack automation

Inefficient Alert System

- ➔ Usually mobile phone, SMS, email and social media. Door-to-door is still common
- ➔ Alerts don’t always include useful instructions
- ➔ Many people refer to social media for information

4Ps Analysis

Product

Real-time evacuation planning

Works offline

Matches evacuees with host communities

Price

Tiered pricing (gov't, remote use)

Low training costs

Affordable for small towns & regions

Place

Cloud-based, works on any device

Pilot in high-risk areas

Northern Alberta, BC Interior, Indigenous Communities

Promotion

"Evacuate Smarter. Safer. Together."

Workshops & events

Backed by real use cases & demos

SWOT Analysis

S

Scalable from small to large communities

Focus on vulnerable groups

Lightweight and cost-effective

W

Data integration is difficult

Steep learning curve

New product lacks trust

O

No strong direct competition

Competitors lack offline support

Rising climate disaster demand

T

Sensitive data & privacy may be restrictive

Bugs reduce user trust

Dominant competitors already exist

Market Gaps & Competitive Edge

Market Gaps

Fragmented Systems

Internet Dependency

Poor integration with ICS

Edge

All in one solution

Offline functionality

ICS form integration

What Would Help Respondents and Evacuees?

- ➔ On-site Personnel Management
- ➔ Evacuee Management
- ➔ Inventory Management
- ➔ Incident Command System (ICS) Form Integration
- ➔ Community Profile Matching System

What Would Help Respondents and Evacuees?

- ➔ On-site Personnel Management
- ➔ Evacuee Management
- ➔ Inventory Management
- ➔ Incident Command System (ICS) Form Integration
- ➔ Community Profile Matching System

Key Feature Highlights

<u>Incident Command System (ICS) Form Integration</u>

- ➔ Will support all ICS forms available on the ICS Canada website
- ➔ Create, import, and export ICS forms
- ➔ Send out completed ICS forms to relevant personnel
- ➔ Automation process for simpler forms, filling relevant information from personnel and/or Geographic Information System data
- ➔ Extract information from ICS forms in order to customize the notifications

Business Model

Value Proposition

- ➔ Reduced manual paperwork and errors
- ➔ Centralized and secure storage for all ICS documentation
- ➔ Automation of simple form fields using personnel and/or GIS data
- ➔ Streamlined the process of sharing ICS forms

Channels

- ➔ Web platform for command centres
- ➔ Mobile application for field personnel
- ➔ Emergency management training programs
- ➔ Integration with various organizations' internal systems (i.e. GIS, HR databases)

Business Model

Customer Segments

- ➔ Incident Management Team
- ➔ Fire, police, and emergency medical service agencies
- ➔ Emergency Operations Centres (EOCs)

Customer Relationships

- ➔ Continuous improvements through user feedback
- ➔ Custom deployment services for complex agencies
- ➔ Training modules for ICS workflow adoption
- ➔ Dedicated onboarding and support teams

Business Model

Key Partners

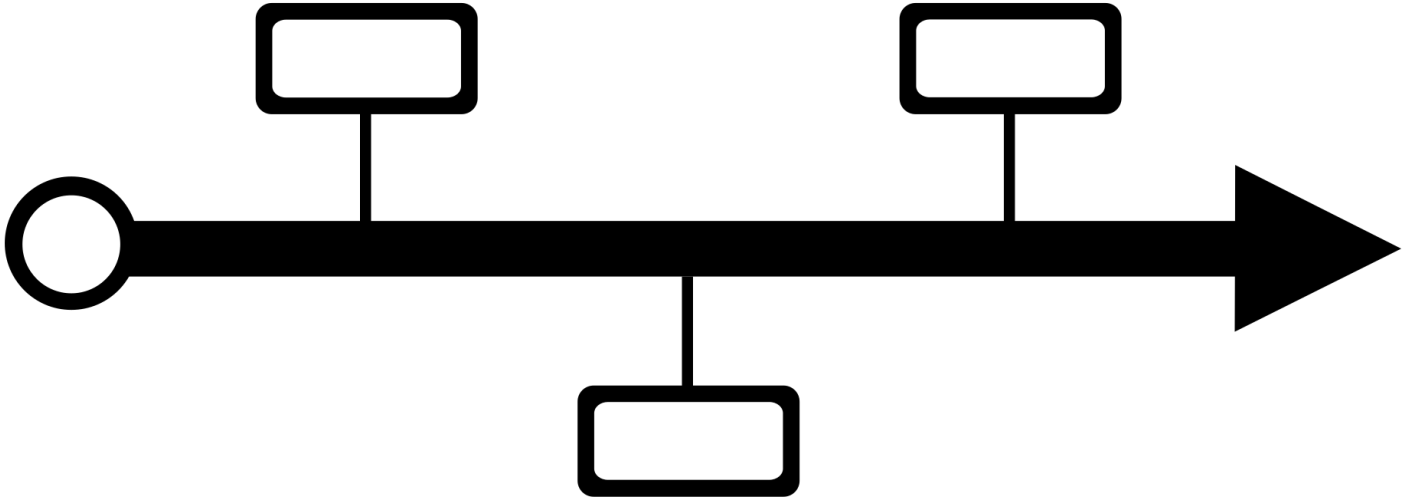
- ICS Canada
- IT infrastructure partners (i.e. cloud providers)
- Training organizations and consultants in emergency management

Key Resources

- Skilled software, mobile application, integration, and API developers
- ICS experts
- Secure and scalable cloud infrastructures
- User experience/user interface (UX/UI) designers for user- friendly interfaces

Next Steps

- ➔ Review the research report
- ➔ Finalize resources required
- ➔ Determine a pricing model



Thank You for Listening!

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Questions?

Comments?